

ACCEPT 7-0

(1 photo)

DOCUMENTATION OF RARE BIRD SIGHTING

Species: Purple Finch *Carpodacus purpureus*

Number of birds seen: one **Sex:** Male **Plumage:** Adult

Dates: Oct. 28-30, 1999 **Time seen:** Oct. 28: 3 times, 12:15-1:30 p.m. Oct. 29, several times all day; Oct. 30 1-2 p.m.

Light conditions: Excellent **Distance from bird:** 15-30 feet

Locality: 751 Willow Lake Drive, Franktown CO

Lat/long: 39104 **Optical equipment:** Binoculars, camera

Weather at time of observation: Clear Oct. 28, cloudy Oct. 29, clear Oct. 30

Prior weather & number of days since change: windy morning of Oct. 28; snowstorm about 4 days before. Cloudy day after it first came to the feeder.

Habitat: Comes to feeder located on a blue grass lawn surrounded by scrub oak thickets, a few junipers, a brushy hillside (Mtn. mahogany, *Rhus trilobata*, and scrub oak), and grassland.

Behavior: Feeding at hanging feeder filled with sunflower chips. Also perches in adjacent scrub oak thicket. Comes into feeder in association with House Finches.

This finch came in with an influx of House Finches: we usually have 5-10, but on the days that we saw the Purple Finch, we counted 25-30 House Finches. On Oct. 31, the day after we last saw the Purple Finch, the number of House Finches dropped back to 5-10.

Field marks observed: (See sketch)

Head: bright red crown, either erected or ruffed when it withdraws a seed from the feeder port. Slight streaks in crown.

On one side, a dark line above the superciliary that outlines the crown patch.

Rose-red superciliary line.

Strong blackish-brown facial patch from bill through eye across back of head; somewhat triangular in shape behind eye.

A rather stout mustache line;

Bill shaped about like an equi-lateral triangle.

Back: rose red continues down nape and blends into pinkish on back; pink background scaled with dark brown feathers, each feather edged buff or light brown, and each distinct--they do not form stripes or bars. Vivid rose-red rump.

Underparts: Rose--pink breast and sides; on belly the pink breaks up into a criss-cross of rose-pink spots, with a thin pencil line of white thrust up through the middle, a continuation of the white under-tail coverts. Under-tail coverts all white, without streaks or spots; the white continues onto the upper side to outline the rose-red rump. Lower sides have one or two dark stripes, right next to wings when folded.

Tail: dark; notched.

Bird's call or song: I may have heard a sweet whistle from the bird once.

Field marks not seen:

Similar species: House Finch: a slenderer bird; red a different shade; well-streaked underparts that start at truncated red breast.

Cassin's Finch: Contrast between rose-red of crown and brown on nape and back; back brown without pink undercoating. Under-tail coverts usually have spots or streaks. Not as much rose-red on breast, and belly usually has a few streaks on the sides.

Prior experience: House Finch: lots. Cassin's: frequently seen, though rarely this well. Purple: some experience.

Comments: We saw several Purple Finches in the East in early October, and other bird watchers thought that in the East an incursion of Purple Finches this winter has already started. This observation may fit into that pattern.

Description from: Notes taken in field.

Also seen by: Urling Kingery, Karen Metz, Rich Stevens, Glenn Walbeck, and 12 members of beginning bird class.

Hugh E. Kingery

PO Box 584, Franktown CO 80116

10/28-29

Franklin yard

12:50 pm -

10 bright red crown

Bill
Super
Equilateral
Triangle

PURPLE FINCH
on one side,
dark super-super
ciliary

erected
Rose-red nape
& lower face
no cut-off to back
Strong blackish-brown
facial patch

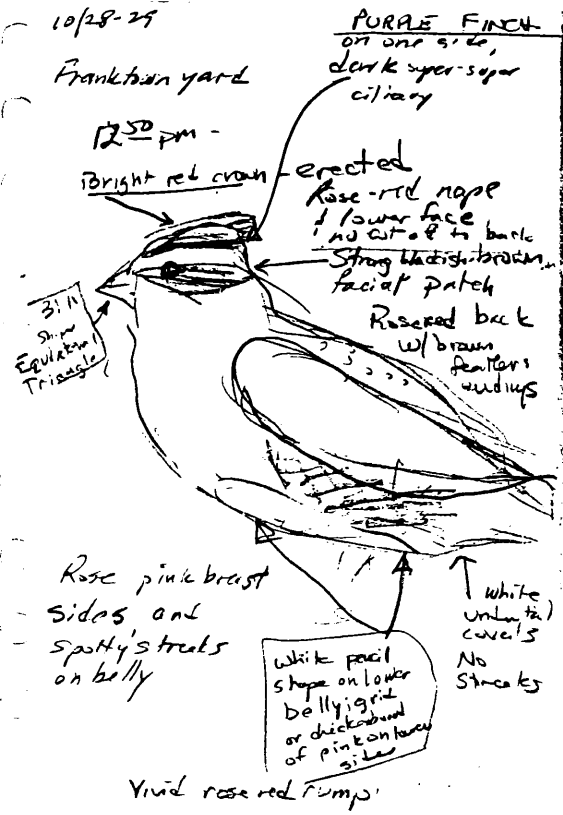
Rose-red back
w/ brown
feather
endings

Rose pink breast
- sides and
- spotty streaks
on belly

white facial
shape on lower
belly; grid
or checkered
of pink on lower
sides

white
under tail
coverts
No
streaks

Vivid rose red rump



DOCUMENTATION OF LATILONG PAPE BIRD SIGHTING
FOR
THE COLORADO FIELD ORNITHOLOGISTS' RECORDS

Species: Purple finch
(Vernacular name)

Carduelis purpureus
(Scientific name)

ACCEPT 7-0

Red
12/15/99
WPL

If you watch birds solely for your own enjoyment, a written description of your observations is unnecessary. But, if you have seen something unusual, and would like to share this with others, a written description is essential. Compilers of regional bird lists must insist that their records be scientifically sound; future bird students--those studying occurrences 50 years from now--must have a written record on which to depend. By providing the verifying written description, you are employing a basic rule of the scientific method.

We recognize that experienced field observers can provide important and reliable records, if supported by an adequate verifying description. Thus this request is an effort to perpetuate your record by obtaining concrete evidence which may be permanently preserved for examination by others in the future. This procedure is required for every extraordinary observation, irrespective of the observer.

Date (s): 10/28 - 10/30/99 Time Bird Seen: am to pm

Locality: 751 Willow Lake Drive Douglas County
Franktown, CO
Nearest town, county and state:

Optical equipment: 8x42 binoculars

If photographed, please enclose copy. Equipment used: _____

Number of birds seen: 1 Sex: M Plumage: adult male

Light conditions: excellent, sunshine, cloud

Distance from bird, and how measured: 20' - 30' on feeder

Describe the bird's overall behavior:

He would fly into the cylinder sunflower chip feeder with house finches and stay for a minute or two and then leave for $\frac{1}{2}$ to an hour before returning. He came to the feeder 4-6 six times a day.

Describe the habitat in which you observed the bird:

scrub oak and on the feeder in the lawn

Other observers who independently identified this bird (Please list name and address):

Hugh Kingery Po Box 584 Franktown CO 80116

Describe in great detail the bird which you saw. Emphasize particularly the field marks used to identify the bird, but include a complete description of the bird. Include size, overall shape, plumage and color pattern; details on shape or size of bill, wings, and tail. (Reference to its resemblance to field guide descriptions is not enough.) Describe what you actually saw in the field.

Tufted red head
very triangular heavy bill
whisker mark easily visible
clear pink breast, slightly mottled
white, clear undertail coverts
several streaks on sides of lower belly
brown eye brow follows around head and down
into back
back has soft pink in brown scallops - pink is not
always obvious - best seen from above

Describe the bird's calls or sounds, if heard; including method of delivery--
i.e., from perch, in flight, etc.:

List similar species and how you eliminated them:

Cassin's finch - undertail coverts are streaked
House finch - streaked breast + belly, smaller

Prior experience with this and similar species:

none

This report was written from notes made during ☒ after ___ observation; from memory ___

NAME (print): Urling Kingery

Mailing address: Po Box 584 Franktown CO 80116

Signature: Urling C Kingery

Return Form To: CFO Records Committee
c/o Curator - Dept. of Zoological Collections
Denver Museum of Natural History
City Park
Denver, CO 80205